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THANKSGIVING

While Khrushchev played for time, Kennedy and many of his advisers believed that they were running out of it. The White House announced a long-awaited presidential press conference for November 20, the first in more than two months consumed by the Cuban crisis. Everyone was expecting a presidential statement on what was coming next: had the crisis been resolved, or was a new and even more dangerous threat emerging on the horizon? Kennedy was eager to declare the crisis resolved, but he could do so only if there was a deal on the bombers, and Khrushchev had yet to give his consent for their removal within thirty days.

Some members of the administration considered the deal offered to Khrushchev an unwarranted concession on Kennedy's part. The CIA and the military were not satisfied with the president's proposal to the Soviet leader, whether Khrushchev agreed to the thirty-day withdrawal deadline or not. At the ExCom meeting on November 16, the CIA director, John McCone, expressed concern about the continuing presence of the Soviet